THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapters 5–8: **Cities and States: The Second Urbanisation, The Rise of Empires, The Age of Reorganisation, The Gupta Era** | Class 7 Social_Science | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** fertile land, iron and trade routes	Favourable conditions
2	**(d)** to control the Ganga trade and land	Strategic move
3	**(a)** many regional kingdoms rose and trade networks expanded	Political fragmentation
4	**(d)** it describes Samudragupta's conquests and ideals	Inscription
5	**(d)** at the meeting of rivers	Transport
6	**(d)** state concern for famine relief	Early welfare
7	**(d)** they controlled sections of the Silk Route	Revenue
8	**(d)** decimal place value and zero	Indian numerals
9	**(a)** they questioned rituals and spread new ideas	Intellectual change
10	**(d)** provision of wells, hospitals and roads	Public works
11	**(b)** diverse cultures and faiths in their realm	Cultural mix
12	**(d)** claim to supreme power over smaller rulers	Imperial pride
13	**(a)** it was stronger and more widely available	Wider use
14	**(d)** they were tired after long campaigns and heavy battles	Exhaustion
15	**(b)** trade, including sea trade with Rome	Prosperity

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	Strong ploughs (1); Clear forests (1).	1+1
17	Tired army (1); Fear of more battles (1).	1+1
18	Trade (1); Port cities (1).	1+1
19	Prosperity (1); Achievements (1).	1+1
20	Advised king (1); Decided matters (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	Iron tools (1); Surplus (1); Cities (1).	1+1+1
22	Nandas weak (1); Kautilya's help (1); Took Pataliputra (1).	1+1+1
23	Ports (1); Roman trade (1); Coins (1).	1+1+1
24	Inscriptions (1); Coins (1); Literature (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Varna (1); Jati (1); Hereditary occupations (1).	1+1+1
25	Direct words (1); Dates and places (1); Policy details (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Hathigumpha (1); Kharavela's victories (1); Jain patronage (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
26	Iron (1); Surplus (1); Trade (1); Coins (1); State formation (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Geography (1); Iron (1); Nandas (1); Chandragupta (1); Empire (1).	1+1+1+1+1
27	Fragmentation (1); New dynasties (1); Trade (1); Art (1); Religion (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Politics (1); Economy (1); Literature (1); Science (1); Art (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapters 5–8: **Cities and States: The Second Urbanisation, The Rise of Empires, The Age of Reorganisation, The Gupta Era** | Class 7 Social_Science | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** it praises the king and may exaggerate	Source criticism
2	**(c)** division of society by occupation and birth	Social structure
3	**(d)** gather information about the empire	Administration
4	**(b)** realistic, wavy-haired Buddha figures	Hellenistic
5	**(a)** astronomy, weather, plants and architecture	Encyclopedic
6	**(c)** they organised crafts and trade	Economic institutions
7	**(b)** cross-checking sources gives a fuller picture	Source analysis
8	**(c)** Jain monks' cells and Kharavela's inscription	Rock-cut
9	**(a)** royal patronage of rock-cut art	Gupta period
10	**(a)** standard money made exchange easier	Convenience
11	**(a)** support of Kautilya and a strong army	Combination
12	**(b)** sea trade was important	Maritime links
13	**(c)** had advanced knowledge of iron	Technology
14	**(a)** skills passed through families	Jati
15	**(c)** princes and officials	Central control

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	Spread dhamma (1); Welfare (1).	1+1
17	Old dam (1); Irrigation (1).	1+1
18	Rustless (1); Advanced metallurgy (1).	1+1
19	Reveals past (1); Gives physical evidence (1).	1+1
20	Economy (1); Craft training (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	Prabhavati (1); Queens (1); Education (1).	1+1+1
22	Rajagriha (1); Shravasti (1); Ujjayini (1).	1+1+1
23	Municipal officers (1); Wooden fortification (1); Markets (1).	1+1+1
24	Weak central power (1); Trade wealth (1); Local leaders (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Iron pillar (1); Bronze statues (1); Coins (1).	1+1+1
25	Standard value (1); Easy to carry (1); Save value (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Role of king (1); Taxes and spies (1); Welfare and law (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
26	Excavations (1); Coins (1); Buddhist texts (1); Jain texts (1); Limits (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Weak rulers (1); Size (1); Costs (1); Revolts (1); Invasions (1).	1+1+1+1+1
27	Hathigumpha (1); Naneghat (1); Coins (1); Limits (1); Cross-checking (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Vakatakas (1); Pallavas (1); Kamarupa (1); Alliances (1); Culture (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapters 5–8: **Cities and States: The Second Urbanisation, The Rise of Empires, The Age of Reorganisation, The Gupta Era** | Class 7 Social_Science | Maximum Marks: 50

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 15 × 1 = 15

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** used red sandstone with Indian features	Local tradition
2	**(c)** they show the heights of Sanskrit literature	Classical literature
3	**(d)** a union of clans or states	Political form
4	**(a)** agriculture, crafts and trade with state control	Royal revenue
5	**(a)** land grants and officials	Rule
6	**(c)** to create lasting structures	Development of temples
7	**(b)** they show trade and authority of rulers	Evidence
8	**(a)** all seven parts of a state depend on each other	Interdependence
9	**(a)** importance of royal women in lineage	Matronymics
10	**(b)** Gupta India enjoyed peace and prosperity	Observation
11	**(a)** Buddhist and Jain texts and excavations	Sources
12	**(c)** weak successors and financial strain	Decline causes
13	**(a)** Tamil poems	Evidence
14	**(a)** calm and graceful figures	Classical style
15	**(d)** location, trade and fertile land sustained them	Continuity

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 2 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
16	Calendar from 78 CE (1); Used in India (1).	1+1
17	Hunas (1); Weak rulers (1).	1+1
18	Standard value (1); Easy exchange (1).	1+1
19	Describes state (1); Taxation and spies (1).	1+1
20	Show rulers (1); Show trade (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 5 × 3 = 15

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
21	Gautami Balashri (1); Women poets (1); Royal mothers (1).	1+1+1
22	King (1); Provinces (1); Local rulers (1).	1+1+1
23	Buddhism (1); Jainism (1); Questioning rituals (1).	1+1+1
24	Revenue (1); Production (1); Roads (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Love and war (1); Trade (1); Social customs (1).	1+1+1
25	Plays (1); Poems (1); Themes (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Decline due to climate (1); Gap of centuries (1); New cities in the Ganga plains (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
26	Rulers (1); Assembly (1); Decision making (1); Examples (1); Strengths and weaknesses (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: King (1); Ministers (1); Provinces (1); Spies (1); Revenue (1).	1+1+1+1+1
27	Region (1); Trade (1); Coins (1); Art (1); Women (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Chandragupta I (1); Samudragupta (1); Chandragupta II (1); Skandagupta (1); Decline (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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